MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years focused on CI/CD pipelines, test infrastructure and build tooling. Hands-on experience building Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster, improving GitLab CI performance, and operating a personal k3s homelab with GitOps and monitoring. Uses Terraform to provision personal infrastructure and applies practical reliability and observability improvements through pipeline optimization, test-result dashboards, and Prometheus/Grafana/Loki monitoring. Transitioning into DevOps and platform engineering, with hands-on experience in CI/CD ownership, Kubernetes-based test environments, infrastructure automation, observability and developer enablement.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD, Traefik, cert-manager, Terraform: personal Hetzner infrastructure; AWS EC2 and S3 learning projects. Professional infrastructure scope: GitLab CI, Docker and Helm-based environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster.
Monitoring & data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Automation & languages: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Ansible (basic)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git
Cloud learning: AWS — learning projects: EC2 and S3 basics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Designed and operated short-lived merge-request environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster, including application services, PostgreSQL and seeded data; enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; helped reduce the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL pipeline-results collection workflow using the GitLab API and Grafana dashboards, enabling teams to identify flaky tests and prioritize reliability improvements.
- Authored the guide used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Operated a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for SSL/TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small personal Hetzner VPS using Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)